

Hyacinth

i thought

the porch light recognized me

because when the house split
sliced by the slamming doors
and sharpening voices

i crossed town
to hyacinth

i was guided by
the illumination
of her essence
the smell
of her coffee beans
the tick
of her clock

waiting for me
just as she did

there would be

yet another night
spent on her couch
yet another morning
bonding
over breakfast
about school
and how i once more
made it
to her porch

we then
prepared for
the ride
home

back to the noise
that led me
astray

along the way
hyacinth bloomed
from the sunlight
she caught through the window
giving her eyes
a settling glow
and comforting warmth
i needed

and my appearance
the water she needed
between seasons
as there would often be
days without
rain

more time

before whistles
overtook all seasons
and replaced conversation
before homework stacks
grew year-round
and rose taller
than her reminders

before missed calls
were simply
tomorrow's call

for hyacinth

to wait
along the grass
in front of the porch

to ask
again
when I was coming by
maybe not to spend a night
but at least some time

to keep blooming
through seasons
i barely noticed

to bloom
one more spring
i thought
hyacinth had

but flowers need
care
and nurturing
attention that
i failed to
reciprocate

ignorant to expect
hyacinth to tell
which bloom
would be her last